

Career Design Survey and Internship Engagement Brief

Coyote Business Consulting - USD Center for Career Design - Fall 2025

Project Overview

This Coyote Business Consulting project supported USD's Center for Career Design by examining student perceptions of internships, career-services awareness, and the barriers that affect career-development engagement. The work combined a literature review with a Qualtrics student survey and translated findings into internal recommendations for campus career support.

At a Glance

Respondents	436 students across academic programs
Interest	62% reported high interest in completing an internship before graduation
Service use	80% had never used the Center for Career Design
Preference	95% preferred paid internships

Primary Research Question

How do students perceive internships and campus career-development support, and what barriers prevent them from engaging more fully with available resources?

Selected Findings

- Student interest in internships was high, but engagement with the Center was low.
- Awareness and familiarity were major barriers to service use.
- Students prioritized paid, skill-building internships with mentorship and clear expectations.
- Common barriers included uncertainty about how to find or apply for internships, financial concerns, and limited time.

Recommendations

- Increase visibility through faculty partnerships, short classroom presentations, and targeted communication.
- Use continuous feedback loops to track student satisfaction and service effectiveness.
- Pair resume reviews and appointments with proactive referrals to related services such as mock interviews, workshops, and job-search guidance.
- Explore financial-support mechanisms, including stipends or employer/community partnerships where feasible.

Portfolio Relevance

This project demonstrates applied survey design, internal consulting, Qualtrics-based research, student-feedback interpretation, and practical recommendation development for a campus client.